

The Glorious Blazing Jewel, King of Tantras

Śrī Ratna Jvāla Tantra Rāja · Toh 396 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་རྩི་པ་ཆེ་ལྷན་པ་འཛིན་པ་ལྟོས་པ་

Toh 396 in the Kangyur is a tantric scripture known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Ratna Jvāla Tantra Rāja, in Tibetan as Dpal Rin chen 'bar ba'i rgyud kyi rgyal po, and in English as the King of Tantras called the Glorious Blazing Jewel. It belongs to the class of Buddhist tantric literature and concerns the interplay of skillful means, wisdom, and non-duality, expressed through esoteric syllables and their associations with body, speech, and mind, the twenty-four sacred sites, and the practices of sky-going beings. The text opens with invocations characteristic of the Vajrayāna tradition, addressing vajra-essence and ḍākinīs and expounding the arising of tantras of skillful means, wisdom, and non-duality from seed syllables. It was translated from Sanskrit into Tibetan by the Indian abbot Gayādhara together with the monk-translator Śākyayeśa, a renowned collaborative team active during the later period of translation in Tibet.

It is completed. The King of Tantras, the Glorious Lunar Garland, is finished. It was translated by the Indian abbot Gayādhara and the translator, the monk Śākyayeśa.

In the language of India: Śrī Ratna Jvāla Tantra Rāja nāma. In the language of Tibet: The King of Tantras called the Glorious Blazing Jewel. Homage to the glorious Samantabhadra.

He he, vajra-essence and those such as the sky-going ones — having gathered well the three gates, listen to the division of the great rālī.

From la arises the tantra of skillful means. From ra arises the tantra of wisdom. Then from a arises the tantra of non-duality. Know that skillful means is the body, wisdom is the speech, and non-duality is the mind. From the intrinsic nature of body, speech, and mind arise the twenty-four. Alalaho, emaho!

How does skillful means arise from la? How does wisdom arise from ra? How does non-duality arise from a? How do these become body, speech, and mind? How are they divided into the twenty-four? Emaho — may the Protector please explain!

The great terrifier (Mahābhairava) then declared:

From a comes the avadhūtī. From this very one the non-dual tantra arises — examine it as the ground and cause of arising. From la comes the root of

lalanā. From that the tantra of skillful means arises — examine its cause, ground, and essential nature. From ra comes the root of rasanā. From this very one the tantra of wisdom arises — examine the cause and ground of ralī's arising.

Ra, because of attachment, is wisdom; it is the symbol of the sixteen syllables of wisdom. La, because it sets, is skillful means; it is the symbol of the fourteen syllables of skillful means. A, being unborn from the very beginning, is the intrinsic nature of non-duality. Non-duality is not the domain of intellect, for intellect and sound are conventional.

The right is skillful means, lalanā. The left is wisdom, rasanā. The avadhūtī is non-dual. Know this to be the essential nature of the ralī of skillful means and wisdom united in non-duality.

The body amidst the dust of attachment is skillful means — lalanā is the body. The speech amidst the darkness of delusion — rasanā of wisdom is the speech. The mind, the vital strength of aversion — these are the transformations of body, speech, and mind.

In the body there are eight; in the speech there are eight; in the mind there are eight — thus twenty-four. The ralī is fixed as twenty-four. The sites are the twenty-four; the caṇḍālī, the pure ones, the ḍākinīs, and the elemental spirits — twenty-four. These are definitively established as their symbols, by the division of body, speech, and mind. The division of sites, ḍākinīs, and ralī — gather that very reality into the three bodies.

First, the certainty of the tantra, then the certainty of the ground of cause and the certainty of the ground, the certainty of the referent, the certainty of sequence, the certainty of number, the certainty of lineage — these are the fifteen certainties.

The Sūtra (sūtra), Vinaya, and Abhidharma are first taught as the lower level for those of lesser capacity. The tantra of what is to be done for those of lesser capacity — after that comes yoga itself. The Yoga Tantra is for taming men; after that, the Yoginī Tantra is for the purpose of fully gathering women.

First the root tantra is taught, then what is called the explanatory tantra, then the subsequent tantra, and after that, the subsequent of the subsequent — ten sequences of cycles, taught in order for those of inferior vessel and lesser capacity.

Like the essence drawn from the heart of a flower, from the outer-most outward, comes the nectar-essence tantra — the heart of the heart of the rālī.

First from la, the tantra of the body: questioned by the heroes (vīras) and ḍākinīs, it is entrusted to the eight ḍākinīs of the body. After that, from ra, the tantra of the speech: entrusted to the eight ḍākinīs of the speech. After that, from a, the tantra of the mind: entrusted to the eight ḍākinīs of the mind.

The taste of the nectar of non-dual primordial wisdom: from the body, the luminous body, the body of the eye — because of its clarity it is a lamp. Like the form of a lion, the taste of nectar. Like the light of the sun, like the rays of the moon. Like the sound of a dragon, like the depths of the ocean. Like the flow of a river, like Mount Meru standing firm. Like dust from a field of udumbara flowers. Those who desire and seek this —

It cannot be analyzed by mere logicians. If one were to analyze it according to one's own preference, the heroes and ḍākinīs would become wrathful and split head and body into a hundred pieces. Therefore, with one's own spouse, one's children, one's district, and through body and speech, one should please the holy teacher and receive instructions flowing like the current of a river.

Kyema! O compassionate protector, what then is the great division of rālī? Please tell me once more the certainty of the twenty-four inner ones. Thus declared the Vajra-Holder: through the twenty-eight that are not abandoned, this rālī is certainly great. For each of them, there are seven great ones.

For one who desires the fruit, the cause itself becomes primary — like a sprout from rice. Therefore, at the outset, do not abandon the cause. The two innately born ones are the cause: the naturally innate, and the simultaneously innate with the simultaneous. The common and the uncommon. This is to be known from the mouth of the teacher; it is the face of heroes and ḍākinīs. It transcends the word of the Teacher who reveals suchness. Pitiful are those who err from that.

The channels of the body, the vital energies, and the regenerative fluid are the cause of the innately born. Those who hold mistaken thought and confusion to be the cause, those who hold what has not established its essential nature to be the cause, those who hold conventional bodhicitta to be the cause — these are the confused and the unsuitable. Those who hold the aggregates, elements, sense faculties, and external sense bases of the lower kind to be the cause of the imputed — how pitiable.

What is the fragrance of a flower of the sky? The channels, vital energies, and so forth, abiding in their intrinsic nature, are the cause of the extraordinary path. How pitiful and distressing it is to misapprehend, not knowing what abides in its intrinsic nature. Ultimate bodhicitta is the cause of innately born primordial wisdom. Without relying on the teacher, one errs from that. Those who hold the conventional regenerative fluid to be the cause confuse cause and effect. Without the condition, the cause does not produce the fruit. Therefore the condition is not to be abandoned.

The wisdom-wind and the wisdom-fire are the condition of the innately born, free of duality. These are not to be abandoned. The karmic wind and fire, too, are to be applied in the same way, and also in other contexts. Taking existence and taking bliss — karma is not abandoned, and bliss also is not abandoned: this is the fourth.

Not abandoning the body, the channels that are the essence of the body, the sacred place, and the great sacred place: these are held to be the fifth and sixth. Knowing suchness both externally and internally — the external is the undivided differentiation — not abandoning the aspects of light and darkness, fullness and emptiness: not abandoning transference is the eighth.

The abode of the cause and the abode of the fruit — suchness is not to be abandoned; this is to be known. In the palace of the jewel, the support is not abandoned; the regenerative fluid is to be taken hold of. If it is not retained there, what has escaped is not abandoned; it is to be dissolved into the oil. The antidote is not abandoned; the two form bodies are not abandoned: the twelfth of the non-abandonments.

The bliss arising from the jewel-support, relying on bliss and the sense faculties, closing the gate — not abandoning the essential nature is one. Having distinguished upper and lower, the antidote of the illusion is not abandoned. Having known joy and supreme joy, not abandoning what goes before is another. Cyclic existence is to be reversed from its course; reversing from place to place — not abandoning the distinction of place. Knowing that suchness is to be transferred in stages, through the lineage of the teacher above the teacher — the distinction of entering and reversing in cyclic existence, not abandoning transference in its two aspects.

As the wisdom-fire blazes greatly, the aggregates, elements, sense faculties, and so forth all become nectar — not abandoning the distinction of condition. Through the pores of the body's hairs, all things both stable and moving,

whatever appears as the very nature of bliss — not abandoning the distinction of essential nature. That suchness is free of the nature of illusion — not abandoning the distinction of the antidote.

The mudrā with beautiful face, wide eyes —

possessing the mudrā — not abandoning the distinction of the mudrā. The samaya mudrā (samayamudrā), the Dharma mudrā (dharmamudrā), and then the great wisdom mudrā (jñānamudrā) — not abandoning the distinction of the mudrās.

These arise from the mudrā of attachment: the samaya Dharma is to be known as the two mudrās of the androgyne. The two great wisdom mudrās are held to be the mudrās of liberation. Not abandoning the distinction of the mudrās.

First is the secret wheel, and thereafter the wheel of intrinsic nature — not abandoning the distinction of the wheels. First is the secret caṇḍālī, and second is the caṇḍālī of intrinsic nature — not abandoning the distinction of the caṇḍālī.

The karmic wind and fire are the conditions of conventional cyclic existence. The wisdom wind and fire are the conditions of ultimate non-duality — not abandoning the distinction of conditions.

Producing existence with the bliss of dripping: this is the conventional action of the white element. Not grasping at existence, arising as self-aware cognition: this is the ultimate action of the awakening mind (bodhicitta). Not abandoning the distinction of actions.

The method of application is the expansion of the channels and the action of opening. Not bewildered regarding the four methods of application — these twenty-eight undiscarded distinctions are taught by enumeration: six men and so forth accomplished through the corresponding actions.

Whoever desires self-aware primordial wisdom should rightly rely on the teacher's method at the right time, receive the counsel of the definite non-abandonments — for this very thing is the cause of Vajradhara. The distinguished fruits arising from it are as follows.

First, the aspect: the bindus, the mode, the one endowed with the mode, the supreme other supreme — these very suchnesses are the six. These six suchnesses are the caṇḍālīs. Each of them, fourfold — the caṇḍālī is twenty-four. The rālī is definitively twenty-four. The outer abodes are twenty-four. The eyes and mudrās are twenty-four. The caṇḍālī and rālī, outer

and inner, are fixed in number.

Hehe! O Vajradhara, hero — what is the cause of the arising of the rālī? What, pray, is the nature of the rālī?

The Blessed One declared: all coarse bodies and hand-implements — these are the nature of the rālī at the lower level of the path. Those who traverse the sky, those who traverse the earth, those who traverse below the earth — abiding in the three gates with their distinctive character: this is declared to be the nature of the rālī.

The sixteen joys together with their supports are contemplated as the nature of the profound rālī. Self-aware emptiness endowed with method is to be known as the ultimate rālī.

The syllable A is primordially unborn. The syllable LA signifies dissolution and sustaining. The syllable RA signifies attachment and the precious. From RA comes desire-attachment: blood. From LA comes aversion: semen. From A comes delusion: fluid. Sentient beings are by nature rālī, and because they are possessed of the five wisdoms, the ten grounds, and so forth, they abide as rālī.

The rālī of the body arises from the crown uṣṇīṣa. The rālī of speech arises from the faculty of the tongue. The rālī of mind arises definitively from the heart center. The eyes of the vajra of body, speech, and mind arise in sequence. From the abodes of body, speech, and mind — from the crown and so forth — they arise. They arise in sequence from the palm of the hand. They are to be received from the mouth of the teacher. This is the gateway of arising of the particular.

Hehe! Sentient beings and buddhas alike possess the intrinsic nature, the grounds and the path. The ten months and so forth corresponding to the grounds — how do the miraculously born and so forth come to pass? Or rather, are they not buddhas?

All sentient beings have been declared to be buddhas from the very beginning. The miraculously born, the egg-born, the heat-moisture born, and so forth — the ten abodes of mind are the ten grounds. The eight consciousnesses are the five awakenings. The abbot is the king of mind. The Dharma robe is the naturally pure intrinsic nature. Abiding in intrinsic nature is the shaving of head-hair. A and HŪṂ are the meaning of mantra — all abides in the mind. Without mind there is no buddha: because mind itself is buddha, even stones,

caves, and so forth notwithstanding — sentient beings are by nature buddhas.

In terms of cause and result as well — the latent tendencies, the pervasion, the mode of potency, the mode of direct perception — with and without form: these are contemplated by the wise.

Buddhas and sentient beings are just the same.

Because sentient beings are buddhas in this way,
and because sentient beings have an intrinsic nature like Ra and Li,
seal the body with the mudrā of enlightened body,
seal the speech with the mudrā of enlightened speech,
seal the mind with the mudrā of enlightened mind.

In the intrinsic nature of enlightened body, speech, and mind,
from the state where all things have become of equal taste,
where could there be buddha and sentient being?

Where could there be inferior and superior?

For one who fully knows saṃsāra,
that very state is spoken of as nirvāṇa.

Abandon all fear and conceptual thought.

In this, everything is wonder —
attend to it well and hold it as sacred.

At that moment, all of the assembled retinue were struck with wonder and fell into silence.

The Tantra-King called the Glorious Blazing Jewel is complete.

Translated, revised, and finalized by the yoginī Dawa Drengwa and the translator, the monk Śākya Yeshe.

Translator's Notes

- The term "ralī" appears throughout as a technical tantric term referring to the channels or channel-system, possibly related to the Sanskrit terms lalanā and rasanā (the left and right subtle channels). It is left untranslated as it functions as a proper technical term in this context, with its meaning partly unpacked within the text itself.

The "great terrifier" renders Mahābhairava, a fierce manifestation associated with Heruka traditions; the Tibetan is རྒྱུ་ཆེན་པོ་, literally "the Great Frightener."

The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as this is evidently the opening of a new section of the tantra rather than a complete passage.

The "fifteen certainties" listed may correspond to a standard scholastic enumeration in tantric classification literature; the translation follows the syntax closely, though the precise technical referents of each term in context would require fuller commentarial access.

- The term *rāli* appears without clear Sanskrit equivalent in this passage; it likely refers to a technical Vajrayāna category (possibly related to the Sanskrit *rāli* or a similar term denoting a classification system within the twenty-four or twenty-eight), and the precise doctrinal content of each of the numbered non-abandonments is highly technical and terse, making some structural boundaries uncertain. The phrase "flower of the sky" is a deliberate paradox pointing to the illusory or non-arising nature of the designated object. The passage ends mid-sentence with the *mudrā* description, consistent with the text being a fragment.
- The term "*rālī*" (Tibetan *ra li*) is a Tantric technical term, here paired with "*caṇḍālī*" (Tibetan *gtum mo / caṇḍālī*); both refer to aspects of the inner heat practice and subtle-body energetics in the Cakrasaṃvara or related yoginī-tantra system. "*Rālī*" is left untranslated as it functions as a proper technical term throughout.

The phrase rendered "the two *mudrās* of the androgyne" translates "*ma ning gi phyag rgya gnyis su*," where "*ma ning*" (Skt. *ṣaṇḍha* or *napuṃsaka*) refers to a person of indeterminate or mixed gender — a recognized category in Tantric literature. This is a genuinely unusual doctrinal usage and the exact referent in context is tradition-specific.

The line "*ngam grog la sogs bems po yi*" presents a mild difficulty: "*ngam grog*" likely refers to cliffs or rocky crags — inanimate things — used to illustrate that mere inert matter lacks mind and therefore cannot be buddha, in contrast to sentient beings who possess mind and thus buddha-nature. The translation follows this reading.

- The syllables "*Ra* and *Li*" in the third line are tantric seed-syllables whose precise doctrinal application here is not entirely transparent; they may refer to specific element-syllables or to a pair of symbolic sounds used to indicate the non-dual nature of sentient beings within this tantra's system. The phrase rendered "fell into silence" literally means "became invisible" or "became unmanifest," which may indicate an ecstatic dissolution of ordinary perception in the assembly rather than simple silence; this is a genuinely ambiguous image and the rendering leans on the contextual sense of stunned, wordless wonder.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.